



Talk to charge

South Korean scientists are working on using sound waves to charge the battery of your phone, so next time you are running low on juice, just talk to charge

Nokia's first dual SIM phone arrives with latest X series entrant

Nokia has released its first dual SIM phone, and is launching it first into the Indian market. While Nokia introduced the Nokia C2-00 as well, the Nokia C1-00 will hit the streets first, and already has a price of ₹1,999. While this is bit higher than we expected earlier (₹1,700), this low-priced dual SIM phone is definitely a milestone for the company. The Nokia C1-00 is a very basic Series 30 phone that offers only voice and SMS capabilities, along with FM radio, and a flashlight. Some of the phone's unique features for its price include a speaking alarm clock in local Indian languages, call tracker, and multiple phone books (one per SIM).

The Nokia C2-00 however, is a Series 40 dual SIM that attempts to cater to those who want a little more from their phone, offering GPRS facilities,

MP3 player, microSD expandability up to 32GB, FM radio with recording, 3.5-mm audio jack, Bluetooth, MMS and a VGA camera. Most notably, the phone will also come with Nokia Ovi Life Tools.

Present at the India-exclusive launch was Mary Lloyd, Executive Vice President of Nokia's mobile phone division, who spoke at length of the importance of India and other emerging markets for Nokia and how they accounted for a significant percentage of the 360 million Nokia phones sold in 2009. In fact, according to Lloyd, these markets have become such major players in the global scene, that it's hard to "ignore" them anymore, so much



Nokia's X2

so, that Nokia wishes to call these emerging markets "blossoming markets" instead.

Lloyd went on to speak about how Nokia has a place in every price segment in India, and its massive presence in the country is unique, especially with its "hyper-local" approach to sales and Nokia Care, as well as dedicated research and testing centres within the country. Her division concentrates on sub-\$125 phones and at that segment, what becomes more important than making the phone inexpensive is ensuring that it contains the "relevant innovation" or relevant features for its demographic. She believes that with the Nokia C1-00 and Nokia C2-00, they have once

again managed this juggling act. In related news, Nokia has released the Nokia X2 officially in India, for ₹5,999. Representing the low-end of the new Nokia X Series, the entertainment phone runs on the Nokia S40 operating system. While it does not offer 3G capabilities, the 2.2-inch screen device is still quite feature-rich, with dual speakers, stereo FM radio with RDS, Bluetooth 2.1 with A2DP, USB-on-the-Go support, Nokia Messaging, native Facebook app and expandable microSD memory up to 16GB.

The X2's 5MP camera is one of its strongest selling points and the phone's battery life is said to be very good as well, allowing for up to 27 hours of music playback and 13.5 hours of talk time. Though it is slightly more expensive than previously indicated and arrived later than expected, we feel Nokia may just have a strong contender on its hands, offering many features at a decent price point and a very trendy form factor. Whether or not the lack of 3G and Wi-Fi will seal its fate remains to be seen.

Samsung launches two new Android smartphones in India - Galaxy 3 and 5

Samsung has launched two new Android 2.1-based 3G-enabled smartphones in India, the Galaxy 3 (I5801) and Galaxy 5 (I5503), priced at ₹12,300 and ₹10,200 respectively.

Out of the two, the Galaxy 3 is the higher-end device, though both phones feature Samsung's TouchWIZ 3.0 UI, 3G connectivity, the Layar Reality Browser, Social Hub and Allshare social networking tools, as well as Swype text input.

The Galaxy 3 has a 3.2-inch screen, a 3.2MP camera with geo-tagging and face/smile detection, microSD expandability up to 32 GB, Wi-Fi 802.11 b/g/n, DNSe, Bluetooth v3.0 with A2DP, GPS and A-GPS, and loads more.

The Galaxy 5 has a 2.8-inch screen, a 2 MP camera with geo-tagging, microSD expandability up to 16GB, Wi-Fi 802.11 b/g, Bluetooth v2.1 with A2DP, GPS and A-GPS, and more.

Ranjit Yadav, Director, Mobile & IT, Samsung Elec-

tronics, commented on the launch of the two phones in India: "In the open OS area, our strategy is to offer consumers with whatever they want. As a result we are offering mobiles based on the Android, Windows and our own proprietary OS Bada in the Indian market. With the launch of these two smartphones, Samsung's smartphone portfolio now boasts of 4 feature-rich models at a price



Samsung Galaxy 3 and 5

range of ₹10,200 - ₹31,500. By the end of 2010, we plan to have a portfolio of 8-9 smartphone models and expect to notch up a 20% market share in the smartphone market."